with the global financial crisis and the two wars that America had begun in the first decade of the twenty-first century. Hence, when China 'blocked' the listing of Masood Azhar, there were no consequences on the Sino-US relationship.

Five years were to pass before the Masood Azhar issue re-appeared in the United Nations. On 2 January 2016, six terrorists attacked a forward operating base of the Indian Air Force at Pathankot. Although the attackers were unable to destroy key assets, ten Indian personnel were killed. The psychological impact of the attack was magnified by the fact that the attack had happened just days after the Indian Prime Minister, Narendra Modi, had made a significant peace overture to Pakistan by meeting the Prime Minister Nawaz Sharif on his home turf in Lahore on Christmas Day 2015.

The evidence pointed clearly to the JeM, which was a UN-listed terrorist entity. In February 2016, India seized the chance to revive its request for the listing of Masood Azhar under the 1267 Sanctions Committee. Significantly, the three Western Permanent Members of the UN Security Council—America, Britain and France—co-sponsored the request. This time, only China placed a hold. It thus became a matter of direct concern between India and China. The 2016 listing request was important in giving several insights into how China negotiated one-to-one on multilateral issues, which was to prove useful in the final successful effort that India made to list Masood Azhar in 2019. India also saw the repeated Chinese attempts to shelve the listing as a manifestation that China's foreign policy in South Asia was neither balanced nor neutral.

While India's objective during the negotiations was singular, which was to list Masood Azhar in the 1267 Sanctions Committee, China had multiple objectives: (a) defend the reputation of its strategic ally Pakistan which was rapidly acquiring the sobriquet of epicentre of global terrorism; (b)